

4-Wire SPI Slave Interface with Internal Register Map

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1. Objective

The goal of this assignment is to design a standard 4-wire SPI slave controller (CSB, SCLK, SDI, SDO) that provides read and write access to an internal register map. The register map is 32768 registers deep and 8 bits wide, addressed by a 15-bit address field. The design must support both single-byte and multi-byte (burst, auto-incrementing) accesses, and must be able to present read data back to the master with no more than half a SCLK period of turnaround time after the address is received.

2. SPI Frame Format

Every transaction begins with a 16-bit header, transmitted MSB-first, followed by one or more 8-bit data bytes:

Field	Bits	Description
R/W	[15]	0 = Write (master drives data on SDI) 1 = Read (slave drives data on SDO)
ADDRESS	[14:0]	Starting register address; auto-increments on each additional byte during a burst
DATA	8 per byte	Register data, MSB first

A single-byte access therefore takes 24 SCLK cycles (16 header + 8 data); a burst of N bytes takes $16 + 8N$ cycles, with no dedicated “burst” bit — the slave simply keeps auto-incrementing the address for as long as CSB stays low and SCLK keeps toggling.

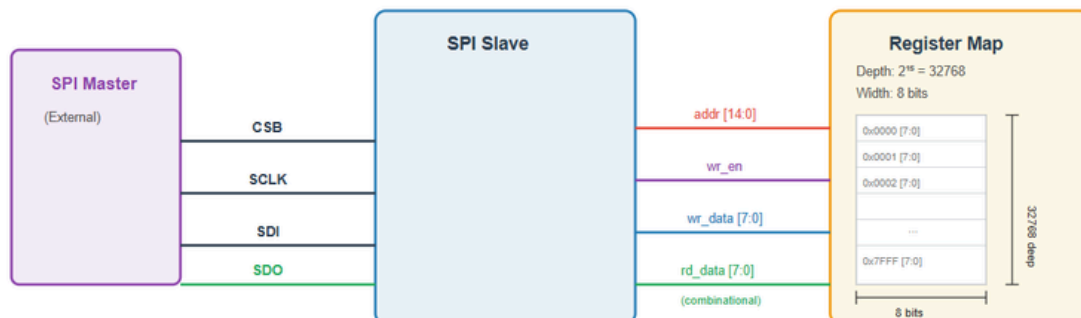
3. Architecture Overview

The design is split into three modules:

- **spi_wrapper** — top-level module exposing only the 4-wire SPI interface (csb, sclk, sdi, sdo). Instantiates spi_slave and reg_map and wires them together through addr / wr_en / wr_data / rd_data. It also implements the SDO tri-state mux ($sdo = sdo_en ? sdo_val : 1'bz$).
- **spi_slave** — the protocol engine: a finite state machine and shift registers that sample SDI on the rising edge of SCLK, drive SDO on the falling edge, and generate addr / wr_en / wr_data for the register map.
- **reg_map** — the 32768×8 register file. Writes are synchronous (one write per completed byte); reads are fully combinational (assign $rd_data = mem[addr]$), which is what allows read data to be ready within half a SCLK cycle.

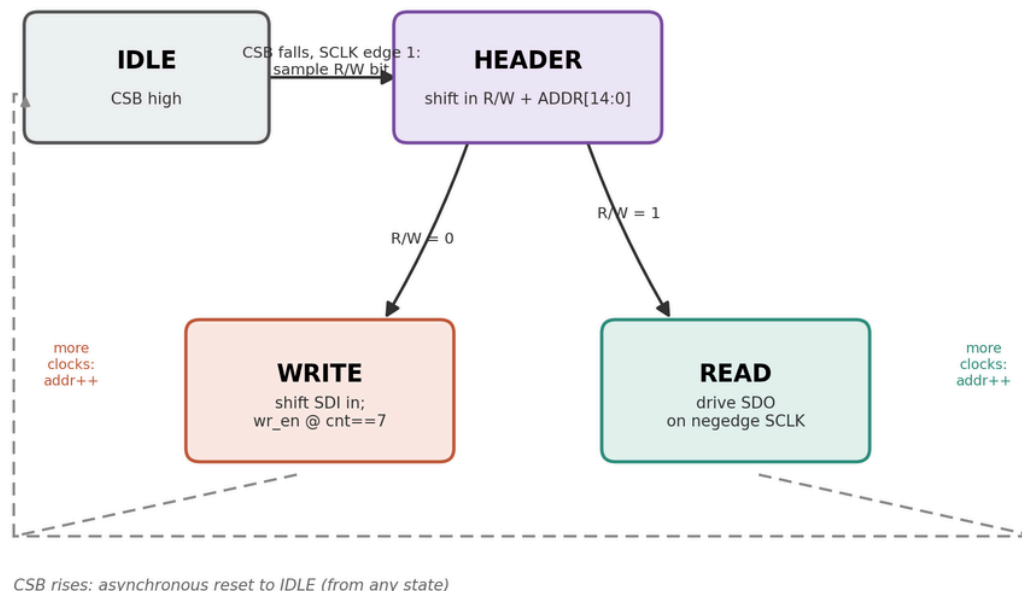
The key design decision that makes the half-clock read-turnaround requirement easy to satisfy is using **opposite clock edges** for input and output: SDI is always sampled on the rising edge of SCLK, and SDO is always driven on the falling edge. Because rd_data is purely combinational off addr, and addr only ever changes on a rising edge, the very next falling edge — half a period later — is guaranteed enough time for the address decode and register read to settle.

CSB is used as an **asynchronous reset** for the FSM and all bit/byte counters: the instant CSB rises, the slave snaps back to the IDLE state.



4. Finite State Machine

The controller uses a 4-state FSM: **IDLE**, **HEADER**, **WRITE** and **READ**. Every SCLK edge does useful work — there are no wasted or “latch-only” cycles, since the master's clock count is fixed at exactly $16 + 8N$ edges per transaction with no slack.



State	Behaviour
IDLE	Waiting for CSB to fall. The very first SCLK rising edge after CSB goes low samples bit [15] (R/W) and moves to HEADER
HEADER	Shifts in the 15-bit address (A14..A0), MSB first, over the next 15 rising edges.
WRITE	Shifts in one data byte (8 rising edges). wr_en and wr_data are driven combinatorially so reg_map captures the write
READ	Tracks bit position for the byte currently being read out. The actual SDO value is driven in a separate falling-edge

5. Module Descriptions

5.1 spi_slave.sv

Implements the FSM described in Section 4. Two clocked processes are used: one on posedge SCLK (or posedge CSB as an asynchronous reset) handling state transitions and bit/byte counting, and one on negedge SCLK driving SDO and its output-enable signal SDO_en. wr_en, wr_data and addr are driven combinationaly, not registered, so that reg_map always sees a valid write on the exact clock edge the byte completes.

5.2 reg_map.sv

A 32768×8 memory array. Writes happen synchronously on Reads are a plain continuous assignment (`posedge clk when wr_en is asserted.assign rd_data = mem[addr]`), making them purely combinational as required by the half-clock read-turnaround specification.

5.3 spi_wrapper.sv

Top-level module. Instantiates spi_slave and reg_map, connects them through the internal addr / wr_en / wr_data / rd_data bus, and tri-states SDO whenever SDO_en is low (: 1'bz), so the bus is correctly released outside of read-data phases.

6. Testbench

- spi_write(addr, data) — single-byte write
- spi_read(addr, data) — single-byte read
- spi_write_burst(addr, data) — 4-byte burst write, CSB held low throughout
- spi_read_burst(addr, data) — 4-byte burst read, CSB held low throughout

Every check goes through a check_byte task that compares the captured value against the expected one, printing PASS/FAIL and incrementing either correct_count or error_count — making the testbench self-checking rather than requiring manual waveform inspection.

Test cases covered:

- Single-byte write/read at address 0x0010
- Overwrite: write a new value to the same address and confirm the old value is gone
- 4-byte burst write, then 4-byte burst read, verifying auto-increment addressing

7. Simulation Results

The design was simulated in QuestaSim. The transcript below confirms all seven self-checks passed with zero errors:

```

# -----
# Start simulation
# -----
# 50 : single-byte write/read
# PASS: addr 0x0010 readback = 0xa5
# 1090 : overwrite
# PASS: addr 0x0010 after overwrite = 0x5a
# PASS: addr 0x7FFF readback = 0xef
# 3170 : burst write/read
# PASS: burst byte 0 (addr 0x0020) = 0x11
# PASS: burst byte 1 (addr 0x0021) = 0x22
# PASS: burst byte 2 (addr 0x0022) = 0x33
# PASS: burst byte 3 (addr 0x0023) = 0x44
# -----
# simulation Finished
# -----
# correct count = 7
# error count = 0
# -----

```

The waveform below shows the FSM stepping through HEADER, WRITE and READ states across the test sequence, along with wr_en pulsing exactly once per completed write byte, and the mem[] array updating for the burst-write test (addresses 0x0020–0x0023 receiving 0x11 / 0x22 / 0x33 / 0x44):

